# The Second British Empire (1783–1914)

**KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & HOMEWORK COMPANION • 30 HIGH-YIELD QUESTIONS**

**Pupil Name:** _____ **Class:** _____ **Teacher:** _____




*Walter Crane's Imperial Federation Map (1886) • Showing the worldwide extent of the British Empire, colored in red, covering one quarter of the globe and 400 million people under Queen Victoria.*

| LESSON ENQUIRY FOCUS | HW DUE DATE | 1. SOLO (WRITTEN) | 2. PARTNER (VERBAL) | PARENT / TEACHER SIGN |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Enquiry 1: Engines of Empire & Naval Power**<br>1805 Battle of Trafalgar, mercantilism, HMS Warrior (1860), Portsmouth Block Mills & Pax Britannica | | / 6 | / 6 | |
| **Enquiry 2: The British Raj & 1857 Rebellion**<br>Doctrine of Lapse, Enfield greased cartridges, 1857 Meerut Mutiny, Rani Lakshmibai & 1858 British Raj | | / 6 | / 6 | |
| **Enquiry 3: Settler Colonialism in Australia**<br>1788 First Fleet, Botany Bay, Terra Nullius doctrine, Australian Frontier Wars & Pemulwuy resistance | | / 6 | / 6 | |
| **Enquiry 4: Scramble for Africa & Plunder**<br>1884 Berlin Conference, Maxim machine gun, Cecil Rhodes, Social Darwinism & 1898 Battle of Omdurman | | / 6 | / 6 | |
| **Enquiry 5: The Imperial Verdict: Drain of Wealth**<br>Dadabhai Naoroji, Drain of Wealth theory, 1876–79 Madras Famine, imperial railways & anti-colonial critique | | / 6 | / 6 | |

**HOW TO COMPLETE YOUR RETRIEVAL CYCLES:**

**1. SOLO (WRITTEN):** Complete your 6 write-in lines from memory without looking. Check your answers in green pen using the Department Marking Bank on Pages 7–8.

**2. PARTNER (VERBAL):** Hand your booklet to a **PARENT, CARER, FAMILY MEMBER, OR STUDY BUDDY** to test you out loud from the Marking Bank until you hit 6/6!

**Scan for Interactive Digital Quizzes & Audio Lessons:**
**Access online self-marking retrieval flashcards, diagnostic feedback, and audio narration at the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app.**

**1.** ► **In what year did Admiral Nelson defeat the combined French and Spanish fleets at Trafalgar, securing British naval supremacy for a century?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**2.** ► **What revolutionary ironclad warship launched in 1860 with 4.5-inch wrought-iron armour made all wooden battlefleets obsolete?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**3.** ►► **What official naval policy mandated that the Royal Navy must equal the combined battle strength of the next two strongest fleets in the world?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**4.** ►► **What economic system mandated that British colonies trade exclusively with the mother country to accumulate national wealth and bullion?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**5.** ►►► **How did naval industrial infrastructure enable Britain to enforce "gunboat diplomacy" across the Victorian world?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**6.** ►►► **Why was Pax Britannica ("British Peace") an imperial illusion for millions of colonized subjects?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**KEY TERM VAULT:** | Trafalgar (1805) | Mercantilism | HMS Warrior (1860) | Portsmouth Block Mills | Two-Power Standard | Pax Britannica

**7.** ► **In what month and year did the Indian Rebellion break out when Indian sepoys mutinied at Meerut?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**8.** ► **Which famous warrior queen of Jhansi led rebel forces into battle on horseback until she fell fighting the British in June 1858?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**9.** ►► **What new firearm cartridge served as the immediate religious catalyst of the 1857 sepoy mutiny?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**10.** ►► **What term describes how cheap British factory cotton decimated traditional Indian handloom weaving in ancient centres like Dhaka?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**11.** ►►► **What historic legislation passed by Parliament in August 1858 abolished the East India Company and transferred rule to the British Crown?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**12.** ►►► **Why did the 1857 Rebellion mark a permanent turning point in British racial attitudes and governance in India?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**KEY TERM VAULT:** | De-Industrialisation | Doctrine of Lapse | Enfield Rifle Cartridges | Meerut Mutiny (1857) | Rani Lakshmibai | British Raj (1858)

**13.** ► **In what year did Captain Arthur Phillip arrive with the First Fleet of eleven convict ships at Botany Bay and Sydney Cove?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**14.** ► **What Latin legal fiction meaning "land belonging to no one" was declared by the British Crown to dispossess First Nations Australians?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**15.** ►► **Why did the loss of the American colonies in 1783 directly cause the British decision to colonize Australia?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**16.** ►► **Who was the famous Bidjigal resistance warrior who led a twelve-year guerrilla war against British settlement around Sydney (1790–1802)?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**17.** ►►► **Why was the introduction of European diseases such as smallpox so devastating to First Nations Australians?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**18.** ►►► **How did the Australian Frontier Wars reshape modern historical understanding of British settlement?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**KEY TERM VAULT:** First Fleet (1788) | Botany Bay / Sydney | Terra Nullius | Frontier Wars | Pemulwuy | Smallpox Epidemics

**19.** ► **What international diplomatic conference hosted by Bismarck in 1884–1885 laid down the rules for carving up Africa?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**20.** ► **What percentage of the African continent was seized and colonized by European empires between 1881 and 1914?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**21.** ►► **What deadly rapid-firing technological weapon invented in 1884 gave European imperial armies overwhelming battlefield superiority in Africa?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**22.** ►► **What imperialist ideology misapplied biological evolution to claim white Europeans had a racial duty to rule "inferior" races?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**23.** ►►► **How did imperialist tycoon Cecil Rhodes use the British South Africa Company to conquer Zimbabwe and Zambia for private profit?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**24.** ►►► **Why was the 1898 Battle of Omdurman in Sudan a horrific symbol of mechanized imperial slaughter?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**KEY TERM VAULT:** | Berlin Conference (1884) | Maxim Gun | Cecil Rhodes | Social Darwinism | "Civilising Mission" | Battle of Omdurman

**25.** ► **Who was the pioneering Indian economist and first Indian Member of the British Parliament who formulated the "Drain of Wealth" theory?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**26.** ► **How much capital did Dadabhai Naoroji calculate Britain systematically extracted from India annually without equivalent return?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**27.** ►► **Why did British imperial apologists claim that constructing 25,000 miles of Indian railways was a benevolent gift of modernisation?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**28.** ►► **Why did devastating famines kill between 6 and 10 million Indians in the 1870s and 1890s while India exported record grain to Britain?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**29.** ►►► **How did British rule transform India from the world's leading exporter of manufactured goods into an impoverished supplier of raw materials?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**30.** ►►► **What is the balanced historical verdict on the legacy of the British Empire?**

**Fact:** _____

**Explanation:** _____

**KEY TERM VAULT:** | Dadabhai Naoroji | Drain of Wealth | Famine Policies (1876–79) | Railways vs Starvation | Imperial Apologists | Modern Historiography

# Department Marking Bank • Part 1

*Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 1 to 3 (Questions 1 to 18)*

**ENQUIRIES 1–3**

## ENQUIRY 1: ENGINES OF EMPIRE & NAVAL POWER

1. ► **1805** — *Nelson's victory shattered Napoleon's invasion plans and established unchallenged British naval control over global sea lanes.* [✓] [X]

2. ► **HMS Warrior** — *Powered by both steam and sail and protected by heavy iron armor, HMS Warrior was the largest, fastest, and most formidable warship afloat.* [✓] [X]

3. ►► **The Two-Power Standard** — *Established by the Naval Defence Act 1889, the standard ensured British naval hegemony against combined French and Russian fleets.* [✓] [X]

4. ►► **Mercantilism (enforced by the Navigation Acts)** — *Mercantilism treated colonial commerce as a closed British monopoly, requiring all colonial commodities to be transported on British ships.* [✓] [X]

5. ►►► **Enabling rapid repair, refitting, and worldwide deployment of steam ironclads to protect British commercial interests in any port** — *Global coaling stations and unrivalled naval dockyards allowed the Royal Navy to project lethal military power to Asian, African, and American coasts within days.* [✓] [X]

6. ►►► **While European great powers avoided major conflict, Britain fought dozens of violent colonial wars of conquest across Africa and Asia** — *European stability was financed by brutal colonial subjugation, frontier wars, and military punitive expeditions across the globe.* [✓] [X]

## ENQUIRY 2: THE BRITISH RAJ & 1857 REBELLION

7. ► **May 1857** — *Sepoys at Meerut shot their British officers, broke open prisons, and marched on Delhi to restore Mughal Emperor Bahadur Shah II.* [✓] [X]

8. ► **Rani Lakshmibai** — *Rani Lakshmibai refused to surrender her annexed state, becoming an enduring national symbol of Indian resistance against British rule.* [✓] [X]

9. ►► **The Enfield rifle paper cartridges were greased with animal tallow (sacred cow and forbidden pig fat)** — *Biting the grease-soaked cartridges violated Hindu and Muslim religious laws, confirming widespread fears of forced conversion to Christianity.* [✓] [X]

10. ►► **De-industrialisation (and transforming India into a captive export market)** — *British tariffs flooded India with cheap Lancashire machine cloth, destroying millions of skilled Indian textile livelihoods and draining wealth.* [✓] [X]

11. ►►► **The Government of India Act 1858 (establishing the British Raj)** — *The Act ended 258 years of corporate company rule, placing India directly under Queen Victoria, a Cabinet Secretary of State, and the Viceroy.* [✓] [X]

12. ►►► **Britain abandoned social reform, retreated behind segregated cantonments, and enforced rigid racial hierarchies** — *Traumatised by the rebellion, the British Raj abandoned plans to Westernize India, viewing Indians with deep racial suspicion and tightening military control.* [✓] [X]

## ENQUIRY 3: SETTLER COLONIALISM IN AUSTRALIA

13. ► **1788** — *Over 1,400 convicts, marines, and officials landed to establish Britain's first penal colony in New South Wales.* [✓] [X]

14. ► **Terra Nullius** — *Britain falsely claimed Indigenous peoples had no concept of land ownership, legally erasing 65,000 years of continuous cultural sovereignty.* [✓] [X]

15. ►► **America refused to accept British convicts, causing catastrophic overcrowding in British prisons and Thames prison hulks** — *With English jails overflowing, the Pitt government chose Botany Bay as an isolated penal dumping ground for transported convicts.* [✓] [X]

16. ►► **Pemulwuy** — *Pemulwuy spearheaded guerrilla raids on farms and supply lines, surviving multiple gunshot wounds before being killed in an ambush in 1802.* [✓] [X]

17. ►►► **Isolated for millennia, Indigenous peoples possessed zero natural immunity, killing over 50% of the Sydney basin population within a year** — *Smallpox swept along trade routes faster than British explorers, shattering family kinship systems and crippling organized resistance.* [✓] [X]

18. ►►► **They proved that Australia was not settled peacefully but conquered through over a century of armed frontier warfare and massacres** — *Historians have documented over 400 state-sanctioned frontier massacres, proving First Nations peoples fought tenaciously for their homelands.* [✓] [X]

# Department Marking Bank • Part 2

*Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 4 to 5 (Questions 19 to 30)*

**ENQUIRIES 4–5**

## ENQUIRY 4: SCRAMBLE FOR AFRICA & PLUNDER

**19.** ► **The Berlin Conference (1884–1885)** — *Fourteen European nations met to partition Africa, requiring powers to prove "effective occupation" without consulting a single African leader.* [✓] [X]

**20.** ► **Over 90% (from roughly 10% in 1870 to over 90% by 1914)** — *Only Ethiopia and Liberia retained their independence, while Britain and France seized vast swathes of African territory.* [✓] [X]

**21.** ►► **The Maxim machine gun** — *Firing 600 rounds per minute, Maxim guns mowed down massed African warriors armed with traditional spears and older muskets.* [✓] [X]

**22.** ►► **Social Darwinism (and the "Civilising Mission")** — *Pseudo-scientific racial theories claimed imperial conquest was natural survival of the fittest, disguising economic looting as moral progress.* [✓] [X]

**23.** ►►► **Using tricked concessions, Maxim guns, and royal charters to seize mineral-rich diamond and gold lands named "Rhodesia"** — *Rhodes dreamed of a British railway from "Cape to Cairo", using private mercenary armies to crush Matabele resistance for mining dividends.* [✓] [X]

**24.** ►►► **British gunboats and Maxim guns killed 11,000 Sudanese Mahdist fighters in five hours while losing fewer than fifty British soldiers** — *Hilaire Belloc famously wrote: "Whatever happens, we have got the Maxim gun and they have not", highlighting the grotesque technological imbalance.* [✓] [X]

## ENQUIRY 5: THE IMPERIAL VERDICT: DRAIN OF WEALTH

**25.** ► **Dadabhai Naoroji (elected MP for Finsbury Central in 1892)** — *Naoroji used official British trade statistics to prove that colonialism impoverished India while enriching Great Britain.* [✓] [X]

**26.** ► **Between £30 million and £40 million sterling each year** — *Extracted through home charges, pensions, railway dividends, and trade imbalances, this capital funded British industrial growth.* [✓] [X]

**27.** ►► **They argued railways unified India, stimulated domestic trade, and allowed rapid movement of famine food supplies** — *Colonial officials claimed railways modernized India, but critics proved they were built primarily to extract raw cash crops and move military troops.* [✓] [X]

**28.** ►► **Viceroy Lord Lytton enforced strict laissez-faire policies, refusing to halt commercial grain exports to feed starving peasants** — *Imperial authorities prioritized international market contracts over famine relief, forcing starving laborers into punitive relief camps.* [✓] [X]

**29.** ►►► **Imposing one-way tariffs that crushed Indian textile factories while forcing farmers to grow cotton, tea, and opium for British mills** — *In 1700, India produced 27% of world manufacturing; under British colonial rule, that share collapsed to under 2% by 1947.* [✓] [X]

**30.** ►►► **While it built legal, linguistic, and transport networks, it was built on violent conquest, racial subjugation, and immense wealth extraction** — *Modern historians recognize that imperial infrastructure was designed to serve the strategic and economic needs of Britain, leaving deep generational scars across former colonies.* [✓] [X]

## UNIT CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS • 4 CORE ANCHORS

**PAX BRITANNICA:** The period of relative peace in Europe (1815–1914) enforced by unquestioned Royal Navy global command of the maritime trade routes.

**THE BRITISH RAJ:** The system of direct Crown colonial rule over the Indian subcontinent established by Parliament after abolishing the East India Company in 1858.

**TERRA NULLIUS:** The legal fiction meaning "land belonging to no one", falsely used by British colonists to justify the unilateral seizure of Indigenous Australian ancestral lands.

**DRAIN OF WEALTH:** The economic theory formulated by Dadabhai Naoroji showing that Britain systematically extracted £30M to £40M annually from India without equivalent return.